

LAXMAN K

SR. AZURE CLOUD & DEVOPS ENGINEER (KUBERNETES EXPERT)

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Accomplished and results-driven **Sr. Azure Cloud & DevOps Engineer** with **9+ years of dedicated expertise** in architecting, automating, and scaling production-grade enterprise infrastructure on **Microsoft Azure**. Recognized **Kubernetes and Azure DevOps Expert** with extensive experience designing high-availability **Azure Kubernetes Service (AKS)** clusters, managing cloud-native container ecosystems, and engineering highly secure, compliance-guarded DevSecOps pipelines. Proven track record in orchestrating enterprise data workflows, implementing robust Infrastructure as Code (IaC) with **Terraform**, and executing large-scale on-premises to cloud migrations.

TECHNICAL EXPERTISE

- **Cloud & Orchestration:** Microsoft Azure (Core Expert), AWS, OpenStack, Azure Kubernetes Service (AKS), Docker, Helm.
- **Azure DevOps & CI/CD:** Azure Pipelines (YAML), Jenkins, GitLab CI, GitHub Actions, Maven, SonarQube, Nexus, Artifactory
- **IaC & Automation:** Terraform (Enterprise Modules), ARM Templates, Ansible, Apache Airflow, Docker Compose
- **Azure Networking:** VNets, NSGs, Azure Load Balancers, Application Gateway, VPN Gateway, Private Endpoints, ExpressRoute
- **Security & Governance:** Azure Active Directory (Azure AD / Entra ID), Azure Key Vault, Azure Policy, RBAC, IAM, DevSecOps Scanning
- **Observability & Data:** Azure Monitor, Log Analytics, Application Insights, Prometheus, Grafana, ELK Stack, Splunk, Nagios
- **Languages & Databases:** Python, Bash/Shell, PowerShell, YAML, JSON | PostgreSQL, Oracle, Azure SQL, MySQL, MongoDB, DynamoDB

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Kroger — Blue Ash, OH

Sr. DevOps & Azure Cloud Platform Engineer (AKS & CI/CD) | Nov 2021 – Present

- **Enterprise Azure Architecture:** Designed and deployed secure, scalable, and highly available Azure cloud architectures leveraging advanced **Terraform Enterprise modules** and ARM templates to enforce standardized Infrastructure as Code (IaC).
- **Production Kubernetes (AKS) Expert:** Architected and orchestrated multi-region **Azure Kubernetes Service (AKS)** clusters for mission-critical microservices, configuring advanced networking topologies, automated node autoscaling, and custom Helm charts.
- **Advanced Workflow & Data Engineering:** Engineered and deployed **Apache Airflow** infrastructure inside Docker/AKS container environments, seamlessly integrated with **Azure Database for PostgreSQL** for secure metadata storage and reliable distributed ETL pipeline execution.
- **Enterprise Azure DevOps & Pipelines:** Built and standardized end-to-end CI/CD frameworks using **Azure DevOps (Azure Pipelines)**, Jenkins, and GitHub Actions; integrated static code analysis via **SonarQube** and secure package deployment to **Azure Container Registry (ACR)**. Built and maintained docker based containers ecosystems including development emulators and multi-service simulation environments.
- **Robust Network Engineering:** Configured complex enterprise network topologies containing Azure VNets, Network Security Groups (NSGs), Application Gateways, Private Endpoints, and hybrid on-premises connectivity via **ExpressRoute** and VPN Gateways.
- **DevSecOps & Secrets Governance:** Enforced strict shift-left security protocols by incorporating container vulnerability scanning, implementing **Azure Policy** safeguards, and managing corporate encryption assets with centralized **Azure Key Vault** integrations.
- **End-to-End Observability Stack:** Created proactive dashboard visualizations, log correlation, and real-time alerts across distributed AKS environments utilizing **Prometheus, Grafana, ELK Stack**, and deep **Azure Monitor / Log Analytics** integrations.
- **Engineering Leadership:** Formulated enterprise operational runbooks and infrastructure blueprints while leading cross-functional squads and mentoring junior engineers on cloud-native practices, GitOps workflows, and automation maturity.

CITIGROUP INC — Tampa, FL

DevOps / Azure Cloud Systems Engineer | Oct 2016 – Oct 2021

- **Large-Scale Cloud Migration:** Spearheaded seamless cross-infrastructure migration projects translating massive on-premises banking legacy workloads to **Azure IaaS/PaaS** targets utilizing **Azure Site Recovery** and **Azure Migrate** frameworks.
- **Azure Infrastructure Optimization:** Managed corporate multi-tenant environments consisting of Azure Virtual Machines, high-performance Storage Accounts, scalable App Services, and highly available **SQL Azure** databases.
- **Enterprise CI/CD Automation:** Engineered scalable integration and delivery architectures via **Azure DevOps** and Jenkins, automating post-commit deployments with PowerShell, Bash, and initial Terraform configurations.
- **Early Container Orchestration:** Implemented early production containerization ecosystems utilizing Docker, Docker Compose, and **Azure Service Fabric** cluster topologies to isolate legacy microservice processes.
- **API Security & Governance:** Deployed **Azure API Management (APIM)** infrastructure to act as a secure, rate-throttled, and heavily governed entry gateway exposing enterprise banking services to validated third-party vendors.
- **Enterprise Monitoring Operations:** Configured centralized log indexing and alert tooling utilizing **Splunk**, Nagios, and ELK Stack architectures to drive immediate incident troubleshooting and minimize production Mean Time to Resolution (MTTR).

CERTIFICATIONS & EDUCATION

- **AWS Certified Developer – Associate**
- **Master of Science in Information Technology**
- **Bachelor of Science in Computer Science Engineering**